

SSC Selection Post (Matriculation Level): PYQ Forensic Report

One-line verdict

Your instinct is useful, but the number “70” is not established by these papers. The audited corpus shows that broad topic families and task frames recur strongly, while verified exact item reuse is rare in text-comparable material. Therefore, prepare for familiar *methods and formats*, not 70 copied questions. The analyses did not define or count “familiar formats” per future paper, so they cannot honestly promise 70 repeats or a precise 68–72 forecast. Reasoning, Maths and English each show strong—but methodologically different—historical structure; General Awareness recycles domains and some facts but is substantially less predictable.

1. What was investigated

Audited third-party-hosted historical/reconstructed corpus

Phase	Unique Matriculation papers	Questions analysed
Phase IX (2021 cycle; exams held Feb–Mar 2022)	17	1,700
Phase X (2022)	9	900
Phase XI (2023)	6	600
Phase XII (2024)	8	800
Total	40 retained papers	4,000 questions

Each paper contributed exactly 25 Reasoning, 25 General Awareness, 25 Maths, and 25 English questions.

Source-forensics finding

The older Adda247 table appears to list 29 “Matric” English papers. A file-by-file audit found:

- 29/29 links were readable PDFs.
- Only **17 were unique Matriculation papers**.
- One was an exact duplicate.
- Seven were actually Higher Secondary papers.
- Four were actually Graduate papers.
- Five rows had incorrect dates or times.

The internal `Subject`, `Exam Date`, and `Exam Time` fields in each PDF—not the webpage label—were used to establish consistent level/date identities. These fields support corpus auditing but do **not** authenticate the third-party files as original SSC releases.

The twelve files advertised for 2025 have filenames explicitly saying “**Similar Paper.**” Their distributions differ sharply from the historical papers, so they were analysed only as a separate coaching-material comparison and **not counted as real PYQ evidence**.

Primary inventories: [Adda247 paper archive](#) and [AajExam Matriculation inventory](#).

2. What is officially fixed

According to the [official SSC Phase XIII/2025 notice](#) (scheme and syllabus on pages 17–18):

Section	Questions	Marks
General Intelligence	25	50
General Awareness	25	50
Quantitative Aptitude	25	50
English Language	25	50
Total	100	200

- Duration: **60 minutes (80 minutes)** for candidates eligible for scribes under the cited notice).
- Negative marking: **0.50 mark for each wrong answer.**
- The CBE is conducted in Hindi and English only.
- The notice specifies objective-type multiple-choice questions. The archived papers show four choices, but the cited scheme pages do not themselves state an option count.

The section counts, marks, duration and negative marking are fixed by the notification, subject to the stated scribe-duration exception. Topic counts inside each section are not officially guaranteed.

3. General Intelligence / Reasoning

Combined result: 40 papers, 1,000 questions

Topic family	Questions	Share	Observed per paper	Appeared in
Coding-decoding	225	22.5%	0–7	39/40
Series/sequence	178	17.8%	3–6	40/40
Analogy/relationship	132	13.2%	2–6	40/40
Figural/non-verbal	106	10.6%	2–4	40/40
Syllogism/statement-conclusion	98	9.8%	2–4	40/40
Blood relation	85	8.5%	2–3	40/40
Ordering/ranking/arrangement	77	7.7%	1–3	40/40
Mathematical operations/number logic	57	5.7%	1–2	40/40
Direction/distance	28	2.8%	0–2	16/40
Classification/odd one out	14	1.4%	0–2	13/40

What was invariant or highly prevalent in this sample

Seven families occurred in **every one of the 40 papers**: series, analogy, syllogism, figures, blood relations, ordering/ranking, and operations. Coding occurred in 39/40.

The strongest recent blueprint is Phase XII. All eight Phase XII papers used only two profiles:

- Coding **6 or 7**
- Series **6 or 5** respectively
- Analogy **3**
- Syllogism **2**
- Figures **2**
- Blood relation **2**
- Ordering/ranking **2**
- Operations **2**

That is an unusually rigid historical 25-question design within Phase XII. However, Phase XI had only 0–2 coding questions and substituted more analogies, showing that a phase blueprint can change; it does not guarantee the next allocation.

Repeated formats

- Infer a code from one or two worked examples.
- Fill blanks or find the next number/letter cluster in a series.
- Apply an $A:B :: C:?$ relationship.
- Judge conclusions from two or three statements.
- Decode symbol-based family relations.
- Arrange words alphabetically or stages logically.
- Swap operators or find a missing value.
- Solve an image-based non-verbal/figural task; the available text layer does not support reliable subtype or visual-repeat claims.

Fixed vs variable

Historically invariant/high-prevalence in this sample: the task grammars above and a 25-question section drawn from a small family pool. Only the 25-question section is officially fixed.

Not fixed: letters, numbers, figures, family members, coding rule, series rule, conclusion set, and the exact topic order.

Exact-repeat result: one normalized stem-plus-ordered-options duplicate group appeared among 894 non-figural, text-eligible Reasoning items. All 106 figural items were excluded from this equality test, and OCR/retyping differences could hide matches. The duplicate occurred twice in Phase IX with different question IDs; none crossed from Phase IX into Phases X–XII. Thus answer memorisation is weak evidence, while method practice is strongly supported.

Reasoning preparation priority

1. Coding and series
2. Analogy
3. Syllogism and figures

4. Blood relation
5. Ordering/ranking
6. Mathematical operations
7. Direction and classification as an insurance layer

Detailed audit: [Reasoning report](#).

4. Quantitative Aptitude

Combined result: 40 papers, 1,000 questions

Topic	Questions	Share	Observed per paper	Appeared in
Profit, loss and discount	197	19.7%	4–6	40/40
Percentage	115	11.5%	1–5	40/40
Simple/compound interest	111	11.1%	1–3	40/40
Speed, distance, trains and boats	107	10.7%	2–4	40/40
Ratio and proportion	94	9.4%	1–4	40/40
Average	90	9.0%	1–3	40/40
Number system/simplification	84	8.4%	1–3	40/40
Time and work/pipes	78	7.8%	1–3	40/40
Mensuration 3D	51	5.1%	0–4	30/40
Algebra	29	2.9%	0–2	19/40
Mensuration 2D	21	2.1%	0–2	19/40
Mixture/alligation	14	1.4%	0–2	12/40
Partnership	5	0.5%	0–1	5/40
Ages	3	0.3%	0–1	3/40
Trigonometry	1	0.1%	0–1	1/40
Standalone geometry	0	0%	0	0/40
Chart/table data interpretation	0	0%	0	0/40

Strongest observed invariant

Profit/loss/discount produced 4–6 questions in every one of the 40 papers. This is the clearest subject-level invariant in the investigation.

Eight families occurred in all 40 papers and supplied **876/1,000 questions (87.6%)**:

1. Profit/loss/discount
2. Percentage
3. SI/CI
4. Speed/distance

5. Ratio/proportion
6. Average
7. Number system
8. Time/work

The ninth major component changed by phase:

- Phase IX: Algebra was present in all 17 papers, usually 1–2.
- Phase XII: Algebra disappeared, while 3D mensuration rose to 2–4 in every paper.

For preparation based on the latest retained phase, 3D mensuration deserves more attention than the all-phase average suggests. That is a recency-weighted study choice, not a promised future quota.

Most persistent solving templates

- Direct cost price/selling price/profit-loss: **40/40 papers**.
- Marked price–discount–profit chains: 36/40.
- Direct average or missing value: 36/40.
- Divisibility/remainder/missing digit: 35/40.
- Basic $SI = \frac{PRT}{100}$: 34/40.
- Ratio sharing/linking: 32/40.
- Combined work rates: 29/40.
- Income–expenditure–saving percentages: 25/40.

Other recurring forms include successive discounts, equal instalments, average speed, train crossing, boats/streams, election percentages, population change, sphere/hemisphere, cube/cuboid, cone/cylinder, alligation, and workers joining/leaving.

Fixed vs variable

Historically invariant/high-prevalence in this sample: commercial arithmetic dominated; the eight universal core families averaged 21.9 of the 25 Maths items. Only the section size is officially fixed.

Not fixed: values, names, order, exact formula variant, and the smaller ninth/tenth topic slots.

Exact-repeat result: no verified exact full-MCQ fingerprint duplicate appeared among 966 comparable historical Maths items. Thirty-four items were excluded from this text comparison, and OCR/reconstruction differences could hide matches. Parameter-swapped formula skeletons did recur.

Empirical 25-question composition

These are descriptive averages—not forecasts:

Cohort	Eight universal core families	3D mensuration	All other categories	Total
All 40 retained papers	21.900	1.275	1.825	25
Phase XII only	20.875	2.750	1.375	25

The all-phase study priority is therefore the eight universal families first, followed by 3D mensuration for recency, then a smaller insurance layer covering algebra, 2D mensuration, mixture, partnership, ages, trigonometry and the official syllabus beyond this sample. Standalone geometry and chart/table DI were absent from these 40 papers, but tables/graphs remain within the official indicative syllabus; zero observed is not zero possible.

5. English Language

Combined result: 40 papers, 1,000 questions

Type	Questions	Share	Observed per paper	Appeared in
Reading comprehension	220	22.0%	5–10	40/40
Cloze test	175	17.5%	0–5	35/40
Spelling	120	12.0%	exactly 3	40/40
Idiom/phrase	88	8.8%	1–4	40/40
Antonym	80	8.0%	0–5	39/40
Synonym	78	7.8%	0–6	36/40
Standalone fill-in-the-blank	75	7.5%	0–3	39/40
One-word substitution	70	7.0%	0–3	36/40
Active/passive voice	43	4.3%	1–2	40/40
Direct/indirect speech	37	3.7%	0–1	37/40
Sentence improvement	14	1.4%	0–3	10/40
Standalone error spotting	0	0%	0	0/40
Rearrangement/jumbles	0	0%	0	0/40

The strongest English blueprint

- **Exactly three spelling questions in all 40 papers.**
- At least one five-question RC block in all 40.
- Every detected RC or cloze block was exactly five questions: 79/79 blocks.
- Q21–Q25 was either RC or cloze in all 40.
- Q16–Q20 was an RC/cloze block in 39/40.
- Voice appeared in all 40; idiom/phrase appeared in all 40.

The historically observed preparation model is:

1. At least one five-question RC block appeared in 40/40 retained papers.
2. A second five-question block appeared in 39/40: cloze was present in 35/40 papers, a second RC in 4/40, and neither in 1/40.
3. Exactly three spelling questions appeared in 40/40.
4. The other standalone types averaged about 12.1 items per paper, mainly idiom, antonym, synonym, blanks, one-word substitution, voice and speech.

The order of RC and cloze is not fixed. Phase IX often placed them in the reverse order from later papers. None of these empirical allocations, except the 25-question section size, is an official promise.

Fixed vs variable

Historically invariant/high-prevalence in this sample: five-question passage blocks, three spelling items, recurring vocabulary frames, voice, and a 25-question section. Only the section size is officially fixed.

Not fixed: passage, blank words, vocabulary targets, options, block orientation, and whether the second block is cloze or another RC.

Exact-repeat result: under the stated normalization, all 1,000 full-item fingerprints and 79 block fingerprints were unique. No same-category, cross-paper pair reached 0.90 normalized token-sequence similarity. This test does not prove that looser paraphrases or shared vocabulary never recur.

The 2025 “Similar Papers” are especially misleading for English: they heavily use rearrangement and error spotting and contain no cloze, unlike the audited historical corpus. They must not replace historical-paper preparation.

Detailed audit: [English report](#).

6. General Awareness

Combined result: 40 papers, 1,000 questions

Domain	Questions	Share	Observed per paper
Art and culture	188	18.8%	2–9
Current affairs	188	18.8%	2–9
History	161	16.1%	2–6
Geography	130	13.0%	0–5
Polity	79	7.9%	1–3
Biology	56	5.6%	0–3
Sports (static)	52	5.2%	0–3
Economy	51	5.1%	0–3
Environment	28	2.8%	0–4
Physics	27	2.7%	0–2
Chemistry	25	2.5%	0–2
Computer/miscellaneous	15	1.5%	0–2

Static versus current

Under this report’s mutually exclusive taxonomy—where recent sports, schemes and governance items are classified as Current Affairs rather than their static domain—the aggregate is:

- Static knowledge: **812/1,000 = 81.2%**.
- Current affairs: **188/1,000 = 18.8%**.

That averages approximately 20 static and 5 current-affairs items per 25-question section, but it is not a fixed per-paper quota: current affairs ranged from 2–9, so static content ranged from 16–23.

Recurring high-yield families

Fine topic	Questions	Papers containing it
Broad history/reform movements	57	31/40
Constitution, Rights and Duties	55	35/40
Sports current affairs	47	29/40
Physical geography/climate	44	31/40
Modern India/freedom movement	44	31/40
Festivals and religion	41	31/40
Government schemes/initiatives	41	29/40
Recent governance/events	39	24/40
Literature and language	36	31/40
Dance and performance	34	26/40
Human geography/demography	31	25/40
Ancient India/archaeology	31	26/40

Also prepare medieval rulers, architecture/temples/caves, musician–instrument pairs, rivers/resources, Census concepts, constitutional Articles, sports terminology, cells/genetics/nutrition, basic chemical properties, and basic physics measurements.

Current-affairs window

Only 110 of the 188 classified Current Affairs items (58.5%) explicitly stated both a month and year, allowing a defensible lookback calculation for that subset:

- Range: 1–38 months before the exam.
- 85.5% of the dated subset was within 18 months.
- 91.8% of the dated subset was within 24 months.

A practical heuristic—not a cutoff or future guarantee—is therefore:

1. Study the latest **18–24 months thoroughly** relative to the actual exam date.
2. Make a lighter pass over the preceding year for major schemes, laws, appointments, awards and sports.
3. Do not rely on a rigid “only six months” rule.

Fixed vs variable

Aggregate tendency, not a stable quota: about four-fifths of the combined corpus was static under this taxonomy; History, Art/Culture, Geography, Polity and current events dominated in aggregate.

Not fixed: exact subject quota, exact facts, current-affairs lookback, and question order. GA is the least predictable section.

Repeat result: one generic normalized-stem collision concerned different subject matter/options, leaving zero meaningful normalized-verbatim repeats. Manual review identified **35 defensible pairs: 6 exact/near-verbatim and 29 same-fact reformulations**. Recycled associations included constitutional, historical, dance–state, musician–instrument and location facts asked from a different direction. Learn each fact as a two-way association rather than memorising one sentence.

Detailed audit: [General Awareness report](#).

7. Master table: fixed and not fixed

Feature	Verdict	Evidence
100 questions; four sections of 25	Officially fixed	SSC notice + 40/40 papers
200 marks; 60 minutes (80 for eligible scribe candidates); -0.50 per wrong answer	Officially fixed	SSC notice
Reasoning drawn from a compact recurring family set	Strong historical recurrence; not guaranteed	Seven families in 40/40; coding 39/40
Exact Reasoning question	Not fixed	One complete repeat among 894 comparable items
Maths commercial arithmetic	Observed invariant; not officially guaranteed	Profit/loss/discount 4–6 in 40/40
Eight core Maths families	Observed in 40/40; not officially guaranteed	87.6% of historical Maths items
Maths values and answer options	Not fixed	No complete repeat among 966 comparable items
English spelling count	Observed in 40/40; not officially guaranteed	Exactly 3 in the retained corpus
At least one five-question English RC	Observed in 40/40; not officially guaranteed	Historical sample
English cloze versus second RC and block order	Not fixed	Changed by phase/shift
English words/passages	Not fixed	1,000/1,000 items and 79/79 blocks unique
GA static majority	Strong tendency	81.2% static overall
GA domain quota or current-affairs cutoff	Not fixed	Large per-shift/phase ranges
Question order in any section	Not fixed	Categories move across positions
2025 “Similar Paper” weightage	Do not trust as PYQ evidence	Explicit labels + distributions conflict with history

8. Final judgment on the “70 out of 100” plan

What the evidence supports

- In Reasoning, the seven topic families present in all 40 papers plus coding account for **958/1,000 historical items (95.8%)**. This is broad-category recurrence, not 958 repeated questions.
- In Maths, eight families present in all 40 papers account for **876/1,000 items (87.6%)**, or an average of 21.9 per paper. This is topic recurrence, not an exact future quota.
- English has strong but different evidence: one RC block, three spelling items, voice and idiom appeared in all 40 papers, and its passage blocks repeatedly used five-question units.

These measures cannot be validly added into a “68–72 familiar questions” prediction because they define recurrence differently. The defensible conclusion is qualitative: **PYQ practice should make much of Reasoning, Maths and English structurally familiar, but this investigation cannot promise 70 familiar or repeated questions in a future paper.** GA will also contain recurring domains, but not reliably recurring facts.

What the evidence rejects

There is no evidence that 70 questions will repeat word-for-word. Under the documented comparison methods:

- Reasoning: one duplicate complete-item group among 894 non-figural comparable items; 106 figures were excluded.
- Maths: zero verified exact complete-item groups among 966 comparable items; 34 items were excluded.
- English: zero exact fingerprint groups among 1,000 items and 79 passage/cloze blocks.
- GA: zero meaningful normalized-verbatim stem repeats; 35 manually verified near/same-fact pairs show that associations can be recycled in altered or reverse form.

OCR, reconstruction and image limitations mean these are conservative detection results—not proof that no other repeat could exist.

Correct strategy: memorise methods, associations, formulas and question grammars.

Wrong strategy: memorise option numbers or expect copied questions.

9. Best order of preparation

First priority: recent retained corpus papers

These files are third-party hosted and some are reconstructed; use them as the audited historical corpus rather than assuming every asset is an authenticated SSC original.

1. Solve the **8 retained Phase XII papers**.
2. Then the **6 retained Phase XI papers**.
3. Then the **9 retained Phase X papers**.
4. Use the **17 retained Phase IX papers** for additional drills and older variants.

Recent papers should come first because the corpus shows phase differences—for example, Maths shifted from Algebra toward 3D mensuration, and Reasoning coding weight changed sharply. These differences describe the retained sample; they do not establish what SSC must do next.

Subject order inside revision

Reasoning

Coding series analogy syllogism figures blood relations ordering operations direction/classification.

Maths

Profit/loss/discount percentage SI/CI speed/distance ratio 3D mensuration average number system time/work mixture/2D mensuration rare insurance topics.

English

Daily RC + daily cloze spelling idioms antonyms/synonyms blanks one-word substitution voice/speech sentence improvement.

GA

History + Constitution Art/Culture pairings Geography/Census current schemes/sports/appointments Biology static sports Economy Chemistry/Physics/Environment.

How to use each PYQ

For every wrong or slow question, record one of only four things:

1. **Rule/formula** missed.
2. **Question template** not recognised.
3. **Static fact/association** missing.
4. **Careless/time error**.

Re-solve the error notebook after 48 hours and again after seven days. For Maths and Reasoning, change the values and solve again; for GA, revise the fact in both directions; for English, note the rule and one original example.

10. Confidence and limitations

- The official pattern comes directly from SSC.
- Question-level papers were hosted by third parties. Their internal response-sheet metadata, dates, levels, hashes and IDs support consistency and source auditing, but do **not** authenticate them as SSC originals.
- “All papers” here means all **unique, accessible, internally audited Matriculation papers resolved from the investigated public inventories**, not proof that every administered shift is online.
- Visual questions and some image-rendered Maths items limit text-based duplicate detection, although they were retained in topic counts.

- Each item received one primary category. Boundary judgments—for example ratio versus mensuration, or recent sports versus Current Affairs—affect totals without changing the underlying paper.
- Combined averages weight phases unequally because the corpus contains 17, 9, 6 and 8 papers respectively from Phases IX–XII.
- Historical frequency is evidence, not a guarantee that SSC cannot redesign a future phase.

Supporting analysis files

- [Reasoning investigation](#)
- [Maths investigation](#)
- [English investigation](#)
- [General Awareness investigation](#)